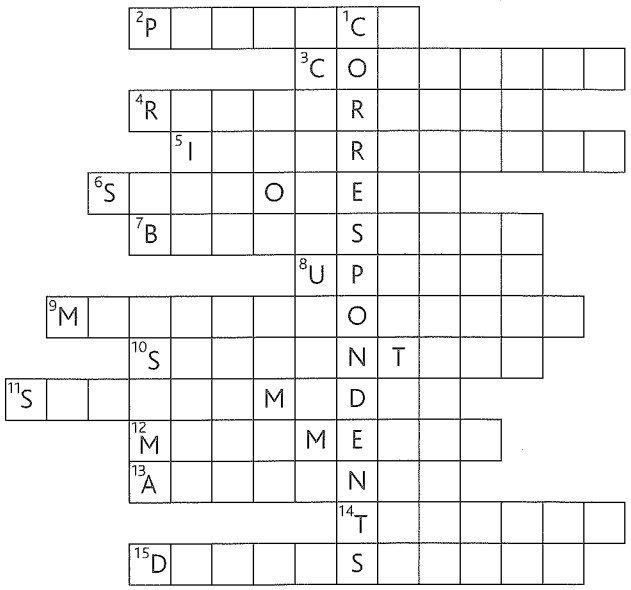
10 MEDIA

Vocabulary
The media

1 Complete the grid using the definitions below.



1 Foreign _____ : journalists who report news from abroad.
2 _____ placement: a type of advertising where a company arranges for its product to be placed in a TV programme or film.
3 The amount of space a newspaper devotes to a topic.
4 The number of people who read a newspaper.
5 A type of media that you can communicate with.
6 A TV programme about the daily lives of a group of people, which is shown regularly.
7 A newspaper printed on large sheets of paper, usually serious in style.
8 To transfer a file from your computer to the internet.
9 A way of sharing your experiences with others on the internet, in a limited space.
10 The amount of time people spend in front of a TV, computer or tablet.
11 Websites where you can share links and files with friends and communicate with them.
12 Media which reach large numbers of people.
13 Target _____ : the group of people a TV programme is aimed at.
14 A newspaper which isn't serious and has lots of photos and stories about celebrities.
15 A fictional, serious story shown on TV in episodes.

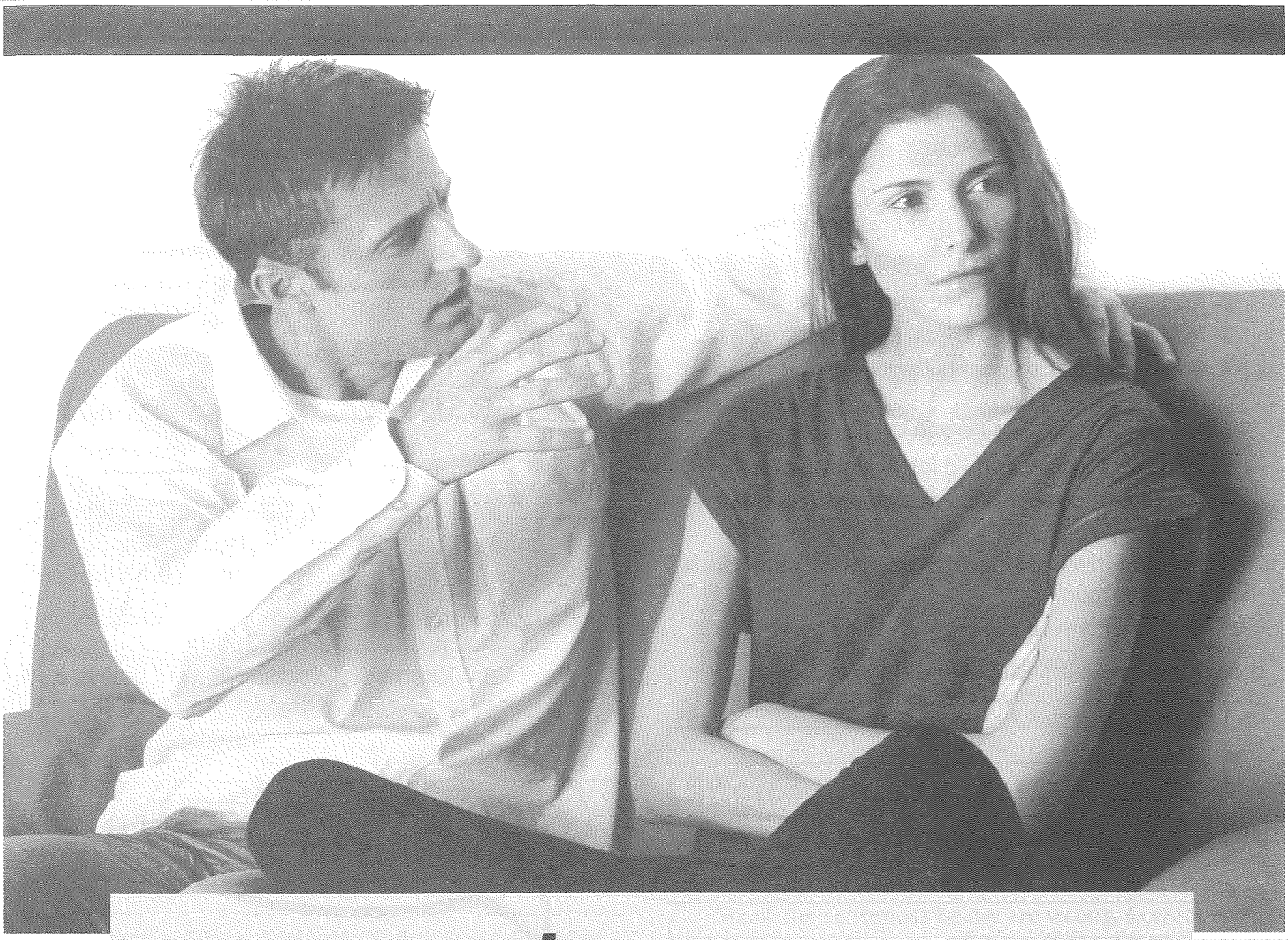
Listen and read
Where's the soap?

2a 10.1 Listen to and/or read the article. Which of the following things are mentioned?

1 How TV programmes aren't always what you expect.
2 The number of soap operas on TV today.
3 The history of soap operas.
4 Where the name 'soap opera' comes from.
5 Some famous actors in soap operas.
6 Differences in soap operas around the world.
7 The future of soap operas.
8 Types of storylines.
9 Some strange examples of stories.
10 The author's favourite soap opera.

b Listen and/or read again. Are these statements true (T) or false (F), according to the article?

1 The author doesn't always see what he expects to see on TV. ___
2 The first soap opera was produced by a woman who used to be a teacher. ___
3 Ninety percent of all radio programmes in 1940 were soap operas. ___
4 Companies which made cleaning products sometimes produced soap operas. ___
5 A 'cliffhanger' is a story which never ends. ___
6 Some soap operas have been around since the 1950s. ___
7 In Latin America, soap operas are called *telenovelas*. ___
8 In the UK and Australia, characters come from rich backgrounds. ___
9 Romance is more typical of paperback novels than soap operas. ___
10 One soap opera showed a dog dreaming in one episode. ___



Where's the soap?

It's funny how TV programmes don't always live up to your expectations. I can't tell you how many times I've turned on the 'news', only to be told who the winner of a talent show is or what a celebrity has been wearing. Or the number of 'comedies' which didn't make me laugh. So it comes as no surprise that rarely does a 'soap opera' contain soap or singing, let alone classical singing. So, where is the soap?

In 1930, the manager of a Chicago radio station approached a detergent company in order to get sponsorship for a daily, fifteen-minute drama about a woman who left her job as a speech teacher to work in radio. This was to become *Painted Dreams*, a serial considered to be the first soap opera. The format was so popular that by 1940, radio soap operas made up 90% of commercially sponsored daytime radio. The word 'soap' comes from the fact that these programmes were sponsored (and sometimes even produced) by companies which produced domestic cleaning products. They were aimed at housewives, who at that time would be at home.

All soap operas are defined by the fact that their storylines are continuous. Several plots often run at the same time, and each episode usually ends with a 'cliffhanger', an open ending designed to make people want to watch or listen to the next episode. Most soap operas are 'open', in that they never end. Some British soap operas have been on TV since the 1950s, though obviously the characters come and go. However, in Latin America, soap operas tend to be 'closed'. Although they last for months and can have hundreds of episodes, *telenovelas* (as they're called there) do reach a conclusion.

In the Americas, soap operas tend to focus on glamorous and seductive characters with wealthy lifestyles, whereas in the UK and Australia, they tend to be based on the lives of working class people. In both cases, storylines are based around family life, relationships, moral issues and sometimes topical issues. Romance and secret relationships feature heavily, and these can be compared to those of old style paperback romance novels. Plots can often move into bizarre areas, such as in an episode of US soap *Dallas*, where in order to bring back a 'dead' character, it was shown that a previous season had all been a dream of one of the characters. Perhaps not as strange as an Australian soap which had one scene showing a male dog dreaming about the female dog from next door!

Language focus 1

Reporting people's exact words

3a Tick the comments below that are compliments.

1 Michael told me that I've got beautiful eyes. ✓
2 Julie said that she admired my honesty. ___
3 Maddy said that I had cheated in the exam. ___
4 Carrie said that she wants to get her hair cut like mine. ___
5 Marcia and Paul said they wouldn't be late. ___
6 Tom said I looked as if I'd lost weight. ___
7 My boss told me that he was going to reduce my salary. ___
8 Tina said it was a long time since she'd eaten such delicious food. ___

b Write the people's exact words in exercise *a*.

1 *You've got beautiful eyes.*
2 _____
3 _____
4 _____
5 _____
6 _____
7 _____
8 _____

4 Complete the conversations, using information from the speech bubbles.

1 A: Why are you wearing a raincoat?
B: They said on the radio that *it was going to rain.*
2 A: I'd love to visit New Orleans.
B: I thought you said _____ .
3 A: Oh, didn't you get me an ice cream?
B: But you said _____ .
4 A: That's £150 for the room, including breakfast.
B: But I was told _____ .
5 A: I'm afraid Mr Cooper's in a meeting.
B: But when I spoke to you earlier, you said _____ .
6 A: I can't find the letter to Sachs & Co. anywhere.
B: But you told me just now that _____ .
7 A: Let's go to the Pizza Parlour for lunch.
B: But I thought you said _____ .
8 A: Come on – you'd better get a taxi or you'll miss your flight.
B: But they told me at reception _____ .

I've been to New Orleans.

The room will cost £120.

It's going to rain.

The food at the Pizza Parlour is terrible.

I don't want an ice cream, thank you.

I've posted the letter to Sachs & Co.

Mr Cooper will be free at three o'clock.

You've got plenty of time to get to the airport.

5a Put the words in the right order to make reported questions.

1 me / her / She / whether / long / I'd / asked / known .
She asked me whether I'd known her long.

2 asked / the / police officer / was / what / I / the / time .

3 witness / ever / asked / lawyer / The / the / the / man / she / seen / before / had / if .

4 often / I / asked / My / visit / grandma / don't / her / more / me / why .

5 dinner / Luc / Vanessa / asked / for / out / like / she'd / go / to / whether .

6 us / asked / challenge / thought / ready / we / whether / They / were / we / the / for .

7 Australia / The / president / Tony / asked / teacher / the / who / was / of .

8 menu / The / asked / see / whether / we'd / to / waiter / us / dessert / like / the .

b Write the actual questions the people asked.

1 *Have you known her long?*
2
3
4
5
6
7
8

Pronunciation

Stress patterns and telling the truth

6 10.2 **Listen to each sentence said twice. In which sentence does the person believe what the other person said, a or b?**

1 He told her he loved her. *a*
2 Alex said he'd done his homework but had left it at home. ___
3 The government said they wouldn't raise taxes. ___
4 The witness said she'd never seen the man before. ___
5 Vanessa told her husband she had to work late that night. ___
6 Joe said he'd left his wallet at home. ___
7 They told us they'd never been here before. ___
8 Vicky told us she'd really enjoyed the meal. ___

Language focus 2

Verbs that summarise what people say

7 **Six of the sentences below are wrong. Correct the mistakes, using some of the verbs in the box.**

agree assure blame complain decide deny point out ~~promise~~ refuse threaten warn

1 Simon ~~threatened~~ *promised* to bring Josie some expensive perfume from Paris.
2 The President refused having an affair with his secretary.
3 The newspaper claimed that Ms Fairchild had lied about her taxes.
4 Tony accused the late nights at his office for the breakup of his marriage.
5 Paula's friends suggested her not to go out with Jack.
6 Sonia suggested booking a table in case the restaurant got very busy.
7 The car dealer urged me that his prices were the lowest in town.
8 I'm sure we'd all like to congratulate André on winning the championship.
9 The company offered to double Jeremy's salary if he would stay on.
10 At the end of the evening, we concluded to meet the next day.

8 Complete the second sentence so that it has a similar meaning to the first, using the correct form of the summarising verbs in the box.

blame complain deny offer
refuse threaten warn

1 Let's hire a van and travel around Europe.
He *suggested hiring a van and travelling around Europe.*

2 No, I'm not going to pay.
She _____
_____ .

3 I didn't break the photocopier, honestly.
She _____
_____ .

4 This food is undercooked.
She _____
_____ .

5 Be careful Pat, the roads are very slippery.
She _____
_____ .

6 If you don't turn that noise down, I'm going to call the police.
She _____
_____ .

7 Would you like me to have a look at your TV?
He _____
_____ .

8 The misunderstanding was your fault, Geoff.
She _____
_____ .



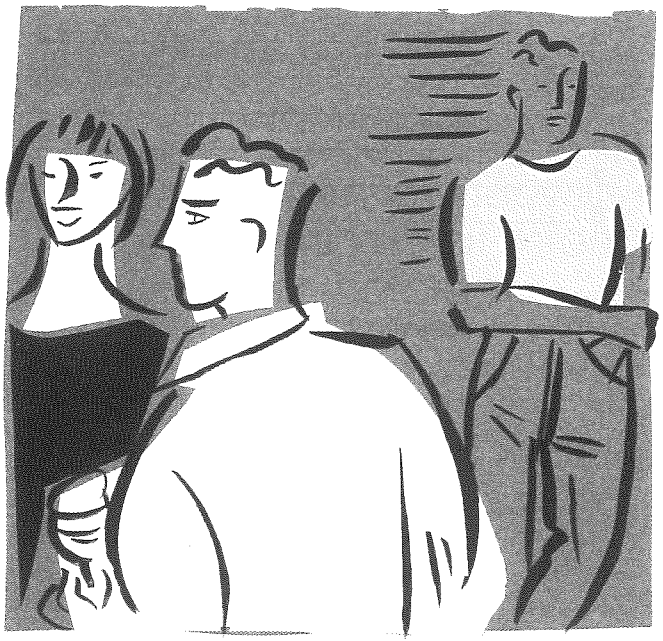
Wordspot

speak and *talk*

9 Put a word from the box into the correct place in each sentence to make phrases with *speak* or *talk*.

about actions mind ~~peace~~ point
radio shop show small terms to
up well

1 After six hours, there has been very little progress *peace* in the talks between the two sides.
2 Is that Frank? You're on *Eastern Suburbs Talk* – what's your question for the team?
3 I've never met Stephanie, but Robert's always spoken very of her.
4 What's worrying you, Todd? Come on, you're not usually afraid to speak your.
5 Are you and Paula on speaking again yet?
6 I bought her some flowers as a way of saying sorry. After all, 'speak louder than words,' as they say.
7 Jon certainly knows what he's talking when it comes to choosing a new laptop.
8 You'll have to speak when you're giving your presentation – it's a very big room.
9 I'm sorry to talk at the weekend, but I need to ask you about the Freeman report.
10 At 9.30 we're showing ITC's new talk, hosted by comedian Dean Skinner.
11 I wasn't talking myself, I was using the earpiece on my mobile phone – look!
12 The national lottery scandal is a real talking all over the country at the moment.
13 Do we have to go to the party? You know I hate making talk with Annie and Jeff's friends.



Writing

Summarise an article

10a Read the article quickly and choose the best title.

1 Why I love ebooks. ___
2 The end of books? Perhaps not. ___
3 How television killed reading. ___

A major online bookseller recently announced that sales of ebooks are now worth more than sales of traditional paperback and hardback novels combined. So does this mean the end of the traditional paper novel as we know it?

I love the availability of ebooks, the fact that within one gadget, I can be recommended a book that I'll most likely enjoy, order it and start reading it, all in a matter of minutes. I no longer have to spend hours walking along endless shelves in a bookshop, trying to decide whether I'll actually enjoy the book I've chosen. My vocabulary has improved, too. If I come across a word I don't know, I can simply highlight it and use the built-in dictionary to get a definition. It's easier to travel light nowadays, too, as I don't have to pack any heavy books that will weigh me down – instead I just carry hundreds of books round with me in one simple gadget.

But does this really mean the book is dead? I don't think so. After all, the same thing was said about the rise of television, and radio before that. In fact, as far back as 1835, Théophile Gautier, in his novel *Mademoiselle de Maupin*, declared, 'The newspaper is killing the book, as the book killed architecture'. You see, the traditional book is a tough character. There's something almost romantic about it, whether it's the smell of its pages, or the way it's like a trusty friend that fits reassuringly under your arm on the train or bus, which tells the world a little about you by its cover. It can be an old friend that we return to when we're feeling down, and our bookshelves stand as a kind of history of our lives, with each faded cover holding memories and pleasures unique to each of us.

What the online bookseller didn't mention when reporting their sales figures is that sales of paperback and hardback books are also rising, and that this particular bookseller, while huge, has only 19% of the overall market for novels. Of course, the ebook is going to have its place in the future, but to say it will kill off the traditional novel is like saying that the invention of online poker would be the end of all casinos. Like television and radio, it will simply become another form of media we come to enjoy.

b Are these statements true (T) or false (F), according to the article?

1 The writer hates ebooks. ___
2 It only takes a few minutes to read a whole ebook. ___
3 You can carry hundreds of ebooks on one machine. ___
4 The writer only reads romance novels. ___
5 The books we keep represent things that happen in our lives. ___
6 Overall, the writer thinks that traditional paper books will always exist. ___

11a The following text is a summary of the article in Exercise 10, posted on a forum. Complete the summary with the phrases in the box.

According to the article ... Apparently, ...
I was surprised to find that ...
I'd be interested to hear what you think.
~~The article is about ...~~
The main point that comes out of it is ...

COMMENTS



I recently read an article on the rise of ebooks which I found really interesting. [1] *This article is about* how ebooks have become very popular. [2]_____, one major online bookseller has reported that they are now selling more ebooks than traditional paperback and hardback novels.

[3]_____, this has caused many people to suggest that the increase in popularity of ebooks means this might be the end of the traditional paper book. The writer disagrees with this though, and he argues that there will always be a demand for traditional books, and that people said similar things about television and radio when they appeared. In fact, [4]_____ although more ebooks are being sold than paperback and hardback books, sales of these are also rising. [5]_____ that although ebooks are going to become very common in the coming years, it doesn't mean that traditional novels will disappear altogether.

What do you think? Do you like ebooks or do you still prefer the reassuring feel of a paper novel? [6]_____ .

b Think of an article you've read recently, or find one on the internet. Write a summary for a forum. Use the phrases from Exercise 11a.